

Canada: US tariff delay points to phase one deal

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【要点】

- ・トランプ大統領はカナダとの間で新たな関税発動を回避する合意に達したと発表し、8月19日の期限を3日間延長して協議を継続する。
- ・本合意は「第1段階」の取引と見られており、カナダが報復措置を撤回・乳製品市場へのアクセスを譲歩する代わりに、米国が関税脅威を撤回し232条関税を削減することが想定される。
- ・カナダはまた重要鉱物へのアクセス優遇、防衛調達の見直し、キーストーンXLパイプラインの復活などを提供して米国の関税譲歩を引き出す可能性がある。
- ・第1段階合意の着地点として、米国製鉄・アルミニウムの新たな関税レート・クォータシステムやオートバイ関税の引き下げ（25%から15%、米国製造コンテンツ50%免除）が想定されている。
- ・本合意によりUSMCA見直しプロセスが加速し、自動車の原産地規則や中国への対応調整などの技術的問題に焦点が当たることになる。

【メール原文】

Trump's announcement of a deal with Canada is likely to result in a "phase one" agreement that removes Canadian retaliatory measures in exchange for S|||||||

Quick take

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What Happened

US President Donald Trump announced in a Truth Social post that US and Canadian negotiators have reached an agreement to avert the imposition on 19 August of new Section 338 tariffs on Canadian goods entering the US. Trump extended the deadline for three days to allow time to finalize the terms of the trade deal.

Our Take

This is likely a “phase one” deal. Eurasia Group anticipated that Trump would extend the Section 338 deadline (see: Limited trade deal would unlock USMCA talks , 11 August 2026). However, no details of the reported agreement-in-principle are yet available, and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney was cautious in his public statement, affirming only that “substantial progress has been made.” Reports suggest the two sides are still negotiating the text of the agreement. If a deal is signed in the next three days it would substantively reset US-Canada relations, accelerating the USMCA review process (likely to focus on technical issues such as automotive rules of origin and alignment on China) and opening

security and defense discussions.

The agreement is likely more ambitious than initially expected, but probably not a full USMCA protocol. When details are released, Eurasia Group will assess the implications for its USMCA scenarios (see: Bilateral protocols are Trump's 'zombie' USMCA endgame , 30 April 2026). However, the outlines of a phase one deal are clear: Canada removes retaliatory measures and concedes dairy market access in exchange for the US withdrawing its Section 338 threat and, more importantly, reducing Section 232 tariffs. Canada could also offer preferential access to critical minerals, defense procurement assurances, and the revival of the Keystone XL pipeline to unlock US tariff concessions, though the details could be ironed out in phase two.

The phase one landing zone is likely a new US tariff rate quota system for Canadian steel and aluminum. A reduction in auto tariffs—from 25% to 15%, with a 50% exemption for US content—reportedly proposed by Washington would indicate the US envisions a broad phase one deal, with auto tariff terms that could apply to Mexico as well. The result would be a preferential trading arrangement that, while short of fully free trade, would give autos assembled in Canada and Mexico privileged access to the US compared to global competitors (see: US-Canada sectoral tariff deals will not revive free trade , 13 October 2025).

Carney has political capital to spare. Assuming the US offers Section 232 tariff reductions beyond steel and aluminum—necessary to get Canada's provinces to remove their own retaliatory measures—Carney is unlikely to suffer significant, long-term political damage from a deal with Trump. While public opinion favors a hard line in negotiations, Canadians are likely to grudgingly accept a deal that alleviates US tariff pressure on hard-hit sectors. However, Carney's soaring approval rating could take a hit, and he needs lower sectoral tariffs, especially on autos, to sell the deal domestically (an ongoing US Commerce Department review of lumber tariffs may address that sector separately). If the two sides cannot agree on autos, the agreement-in-principle risks collapse.

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